

FOR SOLIDWORKS PDM PROFESSIONAL

PDM Variable Studio

Installation and User Guide

Bulk-edit data card variables in Excel —
with preview, conflict protection and undo.

Version 1.2.0 · Free · MIT license

Who is this document for? Anyone who wants to install and use PDM Variable Studio in their own SOLIDWORKS PDM environment. Both the **PDM administrator** who installs it and the **engineering / documentation team** who use it every day will find everything they need here. It is meant to take you from start to finish without any other help.

Target	SOLIDWORKS PDM Professional 2022 (30.0) or later
Platform	Windows 10 / 11, .NET Framework 4.8.1
Language	Turkish and English — one setup
Download	GitHub Releases — latest version
Source code	github.com/aSamed93/PdmVariableStudio
Report an issue	GitHub Issues
Privacy	Sends no data anywhere; all records stay on your own computer



Before you start

The tool **writes** to PDM. Make your first attempts in a **test vault** or a small test folder, and make sure your vault backup is up to date.

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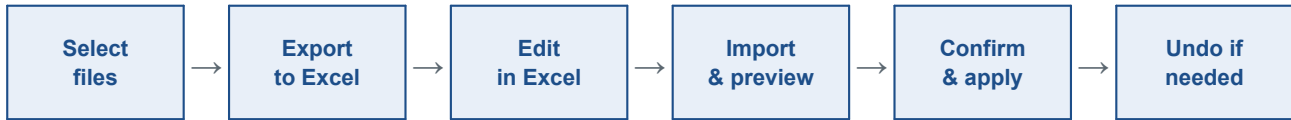
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1. Overview

PDM Variable Studio lets you bulk-edit the **data card variables** of files in SOLIDWORKS PDM Professional in Excel. Instead of opening cards one by one to change the description, material, project code or revision note of hundreds of files, you edit them all in one table and load them back in one go.



1.1 Why is this different from a simple Excel export?

The real risk of a bulk update is not Excel but **concurrency**. While you export the file and work in Excel, a colleague may change the same card in PDM. A tool that ignores this silently wipes out their work. That is why PDM Variable Studio compares **three values** for every cell:

Value	Meaning
At export	The PDM value when you created the Excel file
New in Excel	The value you left in Excel
Current in PDM	The fresh PDM value when you load the file back

Only cells **that you changed and that nobody touched in PDM in the meantime** are written. If someone else changed it too, the cell is marked as a **conflict** and is not written automatically. Details: [4.5 Import and preview](#).

1.2 Key features

- **No writes without a preview.** Before applying, you see why each cell will or will not be written.
- **No silent check-out.** No file is checked out unless you explicitly agree. Only the files the tool itself checked out are checked in; files you are working on are left alone.
- **Safe undo.** Every operation is recorded. When undoing, the current value in PDM is checked; if someone else changed it in the meantime, their work is preserved.
- **Configurations are separate.** In SOLIDWORKS files with configurations, each configuration is a separate row.
- **Database and file stay in sync.** Values are written both to the PDM database and to the custom properties of the physical file.
- **An error in one file does not stop the others.** The problem file is skipped and the reason is shown.
- **Easy on Explorer.** The application runs in its own window (a separate process), not inside PDM Explorer; an error cannot bring Explorer down.
- **Turkish and English.** One setup; each computer picks its own language ([4.9](#)).

1.3 Two-part structure

The only technical detail you need to understand the installation: the tool consists of two parts, and **both are required**.

Part	Installed where	Installed by	Purpose
Application PdmVariableStudio.exe	On every user's computer (or on a network share)	Computer administrator / IT	The main window: export, preview, apply, undo
Add-in PdmVariableStudio.AddIn.dll	In the vault, once	PDM administrator	Adds the menu command to PDM Explorer and starts the application

Once the add-in is added to the vault, PDM distributes it automatically to every client that connects to the vault. The application lives on disk, not in the vault, so application updates never require touching the vault.

2. Before you start

2.1 Requirements

	Requirement
PDM client	SOLIDWORKS PDM Professional 2022 (30.0) or later. PDM Standard is not supported.
Windows	Windows 10 or 11
.NET Framework	4.8.1 — included in Windows 11; delivered by Windows Update on Windows 10
Vault view	Every computer that uses the tool needs a local <i>vault view</i> for that vault
Spreadsheet	Microsoft Excel (LibreOffice Calc also works)

2.2 Required permissions

Task	Permission needed
Installing the application under Program Files	Windows administrator rights (once). Without administrator rights you can install into your user folder — see 3.2 .
Adding the add-in to the vault	An account with permission to add add-ins in PDM Administration (usually <i>Admin</i>)
Changing card values	Your normal PDM user permissions apply. The tool cannot do anything in PDM that you cannot do yourself; everything goes through the PDM API and follows PDM's rules.

2.3 Checklist

Before you install:

- The PDM Professional client is installed and you can log in to the vault.
- The file C:\Program Files\SOLIDWORKS PDM\EPDM.Interop.epdm.dll exists (it comes with the PDM client; the installation needs it).
- You have access to a PDM administrator account to add the add-in to the vault, or you have talked to your PDM administrator.
- You have picked a test vault or a small test folder for your first attempts.

i Shortcut

You can try the tool before adding the add-in by installing just the application and starting it directly ([3.2](#) and [4.1](#)). This is the quickest way to get to know the tool without touching any vault settings.

3. Installation

Installation has four steps: **download** → **install the application** → **add the add-in to the vault** → **verify**. It usually takes 10–15 minutes in total.

3.1 Downloading and verifying the package

1. Open the [GitHub Releases](#) page and download PdmVariableStudio-x.y.z.zip under the latest version (for example PdmVariableStudio-1.2.0.zip).
2. **Optional but recommended — verify that the file is intact.** Open PowerShell in the download folder, run the command below and compare the result with the SHA-256 value on the release page:

```
Get-FileHash .\PdmVariableStudio-1.2.0.zip -Algorithm SHA256
```

3. **Unblock it.** Windows marks zip files downloaded from the internet. Right-click the zip → **Properties** → tick **Unblock** at the bottom → **OK**. If there is no such box, skip this step.
4. Extract the zip to a folder (right-click → **Extract All...**).

Contents of the extracted folder:

File / folder	Purpose
App\	Application files (exe + 3 DLLs)
AddIn\PdmVariableStudio.AddIn.dll	The add-in to add to the vault
install-app.ps1	Script that installs the application
BENIOKU.txt, README.txt	Three-step summary (Turkish, English)
KULLANIM.md, USAGE.md	Short user guide (a summary of this document; Turkish, English)
CHANGELOG.md, LICENSE	Release notes and license

i Why is EPDM.Interop.epdm.dll not in the package?

This file belongs to Dassault Systèmes and cannot be redistributed. Every PDM client already has it: C:\Program Files\SOLIDWORKS PDM\. The installation script copies it from there; for the add-in you will select it from the same place.

3.2 Installing the application (on every computer)

With the setup file (easiest)

1. Download PdmVariableStudio-Setup-1.2.0.exe from the [GitHub Releases](#) page and run it. Because the application is not code-signed, Windows SmartScreen may warn you: **More info** → **Run anyway**.
2. Follow the wizard. The language you choose on the first page (**Türkçe / English**) becomes the application's language on this computer (see [4.9](#)). Setup first checks that the PDM client is installed; if .NET Framework 4.8.1 is missing it downloads and installs it.

- At the end the folder `C:\Program Files\PDM Variable Studio\AddIn\` opens, with the add-in's two files ready. Add these two files to the vault as described in [3.3](#).

To uninstall, use **Settings** → **Apps**. Uninstalling does not touch your operation history or settings.

Installing from the zip package

- Type **PowerShell** in the Start menu, right-click → **Run as administrator**.
- Go to the folder where you extracted the zip (adjust the path to yours):

```
cd "$env:USERPROFILE\Downloads\PdmVariableStudio-1.2.0"
```

- Run the installation script:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install-app.ps1
```

The script copies the application to **C:\Program Files\PDM Variable Studio**, takes the interop file from your PDM client and writes the path to the registry so the add-in can find the application. At the end you should see **Kurulum tamam.** (installation complete) in green. The interface language then follows Windows; you can change it in the application ([4.9](#)).

i Is “-ExecutionPolicy Bypass” safe?

Yes. The option applies to that single command only; it does not permanently change the computer's PowerShell settings. To see what the script does, open `install-app.ps1` in Notepad (its comments and messages are in Turkish).

Installing without administrator rights

Without administrator rights you can install the application into your own user folder. In a normal (non-administrator) PowerShell window:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install-app.ps1 -CurrentUser `
-destination "$env:LOCALAPPDATA\PDM Variable Studio"
```

Installing from a network share (multiple computers)

You can copy the application to a network share once and only register the path on each computer. Updating then means replacing a single folder.

```
# 1) Once: copy to the share
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install-app.ps1 `
-destination "\\server\pdm\VariableStudio"

# 2) On every computer (administrator): register only
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install-app.ps1 -RegisterOnly `
-destination "\\server\pdm\VariableStudio"
```

! Do not copy the exe on its own

The application needs the DLL files next to it. If only `PdmVariableStudio.exe` is copied, it closes silently without opening. Always use the installation script.

3.3 Adding the add-in to the vault (once)

This step is done by the **PDM administrator** and is needed **only once** per vault. PDM distributes the add-in to every client that connects to the vault. There is one add-in for both languages; each client shows it in its own language.

1. Open **SOLIDWORKS PDM Administration** and log in to the vault with an administrator account.
2. Expand the vault in the left tree, right-click the **Add-ins** node → **New Add-in...**
3. In the dialog, select **these two files together** (with the Ctrl key):

File	Where
PdmVariableStudio.AddIn.dll	If installed with the setup file, C:\Program Files\PDM Variable Studio\AddIn\; if installed from the zip, the AddIn\ folder in the extracted folder
EPDM.Interop.epdm.dll	If installed with the setup file, ready in the same AddIn\ folder; if installed from the zip, C:\Program Files\SOLIDWORKS PDM\ — it is not in the package, take it from your PDM client

4. Click **Open**, then **OK** in the window showing the add-in information. **PDM Variable Studio** should appear under Add-ins.
5. Close **all** PDM Explorer and Administration windows, then reopen them. PDM add-ins are not loaded into running windows.

✗ The most common mistake: skipping the second file

If EPDM.Interop.epdm.dll is not selected **together** with the add-in, PDM shows a misleading error such as "...is not a multi-threaded COM-server"; the message never mentions the missing file. If you see it, remove the add-in and add it again with both files.

3.4 Verifying the installation

The installation is complete if all of the following are true:

- In PDM Explorer, in a folder of the vault, the **PDM Variable Studio** command appears in the **Tools** menu (or the right-click menu).
- Clicking the command opens a separate window showing the correct **vault name** and **folder** at the top.
- The variable list at the bottom of the **Export** tab fills with your vault's variable names.
- The window's **About** button shows the correct version number.

If something went wrong, see [6. Troubleshooting](#).

3.5 Additional settings for teams

Shared operation history. By default the operation history is kept on each user's own computer; an operation can only be undone on the computer where it was made, with the same Windows account. If the team wants a shared history, it can be redirected to a network share:

Scope	Setting
Whole computer (administrator)	A string value named JournalRoot under HKLM\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio in the registry, for example \\server\pdm\journal. Overrides the user setting.
Single user	"journalRoot": "\\server\pdm\journal" in %LOCALAPPDATA%\PdmVariableStudio\settings.json

Example for administrators, in PowerShell:

```
New-Item -Path "HKLM:\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio" -Force | Out-Null
Set-ItemProperty -Path "HKLM:\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio" -Name JournalRoot `
-Value "\\server\pdm\journal" -Type String
```

i What if the share is unreachable?

The application does **not** fall back to a local folder; it does not start the operation and tells you why. Making no change is preferred to making a change that cannot be undone.

Language. The language chosen in setup is written to HKLM\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio\Language (tr / en); IT can deploy the same value too. Details: [4.9](#).

4. Usage

4.1 Opening the application

Way	How	Result
From PDM Explorer (recommended)	While in a folder of the vault, PDM Variable Studio from the Tools menu or the right-click menu	The files of that folder are loaded into the list
Directly	PdmVariableStudio.exe in the installation folder (default: C:\Program Files\PDM Variable Studio\)	If you have more than one vault you are asked which one to connect to; the list starts empty

Tip: if you start it directly, right-click the exe and choose **Pin to Start** or **Pin to taskbar**.

4.2 Window layout

One window, three tabs. The top strip shows the **Vault** and **Folder** you are connected to; at the top right are the **language box** ([4.9](#)) and the **About** button.

Tab	What you do
Export	Collect files, choose variables and create the Excel file
Import	Load the edited Excel file, review the preview and apply
Operation History	See past operations and undo them safely if needed

4.3 Exporting

1. Collect the files

The four source buttons add to the same list; you can mix them. The same file is never added twice; the **Source** column shows where each row came from.

Button	What it does
Add Folder...	Opens PDM's folder picker. With the Subfolders box ticked, files in subfolders are added too (default: off).
Add Files...	PDM's file picker; you can select multiple files.
Search and Add...	Searches PDM by file name pattern (e.g. *.sldprt, MIL-*) and/or the value of a data card variable, and adds the results.
Add from Assembly...	You pick an assembly and its configuration; all components of the assembly (optionally also the contents of subassemblies) are added, even if they are in different folders. Each part gets rows only for the configuration the assembly uses and @. Excel shows Parent assembly , Level and Quantity columns; they are for information only and are never written to PDM.
Remove Selected / Clear List	Removes the rows you ticked, or the whole list.

2. Choose the variables

In the **Variables to export** list at the bottom, leave only the ones you want to edit ticked (**Select all / Clear all**). Fewer columns mean easier navigation in Excel and fewer mistakes.

3. Export

Save the .xlsx file with the **Export...** button. Then open it right away with **Open in Excel**, or find it in Windows Explorer with **Show in Folder**.

i SOLIDWORKS files with configurations

Each configuration is **a separate row**. The @ row is the configuration-independent, file-level value (SOLIDWORKS's **Custom** tab) and is kept separate from the named configurations. Files without configurations (e.g. .docx, .pdf) have a single row.

4.4 Editing in Excel

You can	Do not
✓ Change value cells	X Delete or change the hidden _Rows and _Metadata sheets — the matching information lives there
✓ Sort, filter and delete rows	X Clear a filled cell by accident — clearing means “delete the value”
✓ Hide, widen and format columns	X Expect new rows to create files — new rows are skipped
✓ Type numbers in your own regional format (12.4 or 12,4)	X Try to change the file name, folder or configuration columns (they are locked)
✓ Save the file and load it back days later	

The application matches rows by IDs hidden inside the file, not by order or header. That is why sorting or deleting rows is safe. A row that looks suspicious is not applied at all — skipping is always preferred to writing to the wrong file.

The headers in Excel are in the interface language at the time of the export. A file exported with the English interface imports without problems in the Turkish interface (and vice versa).

4.5 Import and preview

1. On the **Import** tab, open the file you edited with **Select workbook...**

- The application reads fresh values from PDM and creates a preview row for every cell. The table shows the **At export**, **New in Excel** and **Current in PDM** values side by side.

Status	Meaning	What happens
✓ Safe	You changed it; nobody touched it in PDM since the export	Applied (selected by default)
· Unchanged	Not edited in Excel	Skipped
· Already applied	PDM already has the same value (someone else wrote it)	Skipped; no unnecessary write
⚠ Conflict	You changed it and someone else wrote a different value in PDM	Not applied , cannot be selected. See the note below.
✗ Error	Type mismatch (e.g. text in a number field), file not found, damaged row, etc.	Not applied ; the reason is in the Reason column and the tooltip

Every status is shown with **icon + text + color**, so no information is lost even if colors are hard to tell apart. Hovering over a row shows a tooltip with the reason and what to do.

Filters: **Changes only**, **Conflicts**, **Errors** and the search box (by file name, variable or value). Use **Select safe changes** / **Clear selection** to change the selection in bulk.



If you see a conflict

This is a safety measure that protects your colleague's change. Look at the **Current in PDM** value; if you still think your value is right, **export** again, repeat your change in the new file and import it. That way the decision is made knowingly.

4.6 Applying the changes

- Check-out consent.** Changing a card value in PDM requires the file to be checked out. When needed, a yellow warning strip appears; **Apply** stays disabled until you tick **"I understand, check out the files"**.
- Check-in option.** With **"Check in the files we checked out when finished (creates a new version)"** on, the tool checks in the files it checked out at the end (each creates a new version). You can type a check-in comment in the box next to it. When it is off, the files stay checked out to you.
- Click **Apply**. Progress is shown in the status bar at the bottom; you can interrupt with **Stop** if needed.

Good to know:

- Files **you already had checked out** are **not** checked in at the end, so your work on them is not disturbed.
- Files **checked out by someone else** are skipped and the reason is shown.
- If writing fails for a file, the tool's check-out is undone; the file is left untouched. The other files keep being processed.
- A file open in SOLIDWORKS cannot be written; close it and apply again for that file.

4.7 Operation history and undo

Every apply is listed on the **Operation History** tab (date, user, scope, result). To undo:

- Select the operation in the list.
- Click **Preview undo**. The tool checks the current PDM value of every cell.
- Review the preview and click **Undo**.

Status in the preview	Meaning	What happens
✓ Safe	The value is still the one you wrote	Reverted to the old value
· Already reverted	The value is already back to the old one	Skipped
⚠ Conflict	Someone changed the value after you	Left untouched — their work is preserved
✗ Unavailable	The file cannot be found, cannot be accessed, etc.	Skipped; the reason is shown

An undo is also an operation and is recorded in the history. By default the operation history is per user and per computer — [3.5](#).

4.8 Example scenario

“I need to update the Material and Description values of the 120 parts in the Project-A folder.”

1. In PDM Explorer, right-click the **Project-A** folder → **PDM Variable Studio**. The files are loaded into the list. If you need subfolders too, tick **Subfolders** and add the folder again with **Add Folder...**
2. In the variable list click **Clear all** and tick only *Material* and *Description*.
3. **Export...** → *ProjectA_material.xlsx* → **Open in Excel**.
4. In Excel, filter the Material column and update the values; save and close.
5. **Import** → **Select workbook...** → the same file. The preview shows, for example, *118 safe changes, 2 conflicts*.
6. Look at the two rows with the **Conflicts** filter: a colleague updated those two files in the meantime. If their values are right, leave them.
7. Tick the check-out consent and the check-in option (comment: *Material update*) and click **Apply**.
8. If you notice a mistake: **Operation History** → select the operation → **Preview undo** → **Undo**.

4.9 Interface language

The application and the add-in work in **Turkish** and **English**. There is one setup and one add-in: every computer that uses the same vault picks its own language. The language is chosen in this order:

1. The language you pick in the **language box** at the top right (HKCU\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio\Language).
2. The language chosen in setup (HKLM\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio\Language); IT can also deploy this value.
3. The Windows display language: Turkish on Turkish Windows, English otherwise.

When you change it in the language box, the application offers to restart; the file list and preview are reset, the operation history is not affected. The tooltip in the PDM Explorer menu changes the next time Explorer starts.

i The language does not change the data

Numbers and dates are always read with the Windows regional settings. A workbook exported with the English interface imports without problems in the Turkish interface (and vice versa); only the headers in Excel are in the language of the export. The log file (*studio.log*) is always in Turkish.

5. Files and settings

Everything the application writes is on this computer, under %LOCALAPPDATA%\PdmVariableStudio\. The easiest way to open the folder: **About** in the application → the button on the relevant row. Or type %LOCALAPPDATA%\PdmVariableStudio in the Windows Explorer address bar.

File	Contents	If deleted
studio.log	Application and add-in log (in Turkish). Attach it when reporting a problem.	No problem; it is recreated
journal\<vault>\	Operation history — undo works from here.	Cannot be undone! Do not delete.
settings.json	Preferences: subfolders, check-in option and comment, last folder, operation history location.	Defaults are used

All files are plain text and can be read with Notepad. The application does not connect to the internet and sends no data anywhere. The interface language is stored in the registry ([4.9](#)).

5.1 The About window

The **About** button at the top right shows the version, the interface language and where it comes from, the locations of the log / operation history / settings files (each one click away) and the project links. **Copy Info** copies all of this to the clipboard; just paste it when asking for support.

6. Troubleshooting

The first place to look is always studio.log ([5. Files and settings](#)). Log lines are in Turkish; add-in lines carry the [eklenti] (add-in) tag and show the flow step by step:

```
[BILGI] [eklenti] Eklenti yüklendi, komut kaydedildi.    ← add-in loaded
[BILGI] [eklenti] Komut tetiklendi (veri sayısı: 1).     ← command clicked
[BILGI] [eklenti] Seçili klasör: Parts (#42).
[BILGI] [eklenti] Uygulama başlatılıyor: ...             ← starting the application
```

The command does not appear in the menu.

- Did you close and reopen all PDM Explorer windows? The add-in is only loaded into newly opened windows.
- In PDM Administration, is **PDM Variable Studio** listed under vault → **Add-ins**?
- Is there an “*Eklenti yüklendi*” (add-in loaded) line in the log? If not, the add-in was not loaded.

“...is not a multi-threaded COM-server” error while loading the add-in.

- EPDM.Interop.epdm.dll was not selected together with the add-in. Remove the add-in and add it again with both files ([3.3](#)).

“Server Busy” / “Other program is busy” message while updating the add-in.

- There is no risk of data loss; **Retry** is safe. If it persists: close all PDM windows and PdmVariableStudio.exe, remove the old add-in in Administration, **close all windows again**, then open Administration and add the two files.

I click the command and nothing happens, or “application not found” appears.

- The application is not installed on this computer or is in another folder. The message says where the application was looked for. Run `install-app.ps1` again; it fixes the registry value.
- If the message mentions missing DLLs, the installation is incomplete; run the script again as administrator.

“Startup failed” / “Could not connect to vault”.

- This computer needs a *vault view* for that vault and you must be logged in to PDM. Details are in `studio.log`.

The installation script says “administrator rights required”.

- Open PowerShell with **Run as administrator**, or use the [installation without administrator rights](#) method.

The installation script says “EPDM.Interop.epdm.dll not found”.

- The PDM client is not installed on this computer or is in a different folder. The application cannot run without the PDM client.

“Running scripts is disabled on this system” error.

- Make sure you run the command exactly as `powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install-app.ps1`. If a corporate group policy still blocks it, ask your IT team for help.

Windows SmartScreen shows an “unrecognized app” warning.

- The application is not code-signed (signing certificates are not free). After comparing the zip's SHA-256 value with the release page ([3.1](#)), you can choose **More info** → **Run anyway**.

The workbook was rejected.

- The `_Rows` / `_Metadata` sheet was deleted or changed, or the file comes from another vault or an incompatible version. Export again and move your changes to the new file. **Nothing** from a rejected file is written to PDM.

Rows in the preview are blocked with “File not found”.

- The file was deleted after the export, moved to another folder, or deleted and **re-added** with the same name. A re-added file gets a new ID in PDM; the old workbook does not recognize it. These rows are skipped on purpose to avoid writing to the wrong file. Export the folder again and move your changes to the new file.

A file reports “open in another application” / locked.

- The file is open in SOLIDWORKS or another program. Close it and apply again for that file; the other files are not affected.

Numbers look wrong (e.g. 12,4 → 124).

- The tool tells Turkish and English decimal formats apart correctly. If you still see an unexpected value, **do not apply**; report it with a screenshot of the preview.

I cannot undo an operation made on another computer.

- By default the operation history is per computer and per user. Shared history for teams: [3.5](#).

The application opens in the wrong language.

- Pick the language in the language box at the top right; the choice is stored for this Windows user. Order of precedence: [4.9](#).

7. Updating and uninstalling

7.1 Upgrading to a new version

Part	When	How
Application	With every new version	Run the new setup file (or download the new zip and run <code>install-app.ps1</code> again). Close the application window first. Closing PDM Explorer is not needed. Your operation history and settings are kept.
Add-in	Only if the release notes say “ add-in updated ” (“eklenti güncellendi”)	Administration → Add-ins → update the existing add-in with the new <code>PdmVariableStudio.AddIn.dll</code> and <code>EPDM.Interop.epdm.dll</code> , then close and reopen all PDM windows.

Release notes: [GitHub Releases](#) and `CHANGELOG.md` in the package (in Turkish).

7.2 Uninstalling

- Add-in (PDM administrator):** Administration → vault → **Add-ins** → right-click **PDM Variable Studio** → **Remove**. Then close and reopen all PDM windows.
- Application:** close the application window and delete the installation folder (default: `C:\Program Files\PDM Variable Studio\`). If you installed with the setup file, use **Settings** → **Apps** instead.
- Registry:** in an administrator PowerShell:

```
Remove-Item "HKLM:\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio" -Recurse # standard installation
Remove-Item "HKCU:\SOFTWARE\PdmVariableStudio" -Recurse # -CurrentUser installation, language choice
```

- User data (optional):** the `%LOCALAPPDATA%\PdmVariableStudio\` folder.

! Think twice before deleting the operation history

If the `journal` subfolder is deleted, the changes made until then can no longer be undone with the tool. If in doubt, back it up and keep it.

8. Support, license and privacy

8.1 Reporting a problem

Report problems and suggestions on the [GitHub Issues](#) page. For a quick fix, include:

- The output of **About** → **Copy Info** (version and file locations)
- The `studio.log` file
- What you did, what you expected and what happened; a screenshot if possible

! Before sharing

Workbooks and log files contain vault data (file names, card values, user names). Remove confidential information before attaching them to a public page.

8.2 License

PDM Variable Studio is distributed under the **MIT license**: it is free, there is no license key, and commercial use, modification and distribution are allowed. The software is provided “as is”, without any warranty. Full text:

[LICENSE](#).

8.3 Privacy and security

- The application does not connect to the internet, collects no telemetry and sends no data anywhere.
- It never writes to the PDM database with SQL directly; every operation goes through the PDM API, within your PDM permissions and workflow rules.
- The complete source code is open [on GitHub](#) and can be reviewed.

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